

The Hong Kong Polytechnic University

Subject Description Form

Subject Code	ITC1CN02
Subject Title	Fashion and Culture
Credit Value	3 credits
Level	1
Pre-requisite/ Co-requisite/ Exclusion	Nil
Objectives	Fashion has been used as a barometer to understand the contemporary social and cultural contexts because it embodies the spirit of the time. Every aspect of society including lifestyle, taste, moral and aesthetic values, economy, politics, and customs are all integrated within the clothes people wear for specific times and places. This subject aims to provide the fundamental and essential knowledge of fashion and culture, as well as the integral relationship between the two, built throughout history for students who want to understand various aspects of contemporary culture, such as art, music, film and other significant issues of society manifest in fashion. Throughout the course, students are expected to read a wide range of written references to build their own knowledge and resources for comprehending contemporary culture and fashion.
Intended Learning Outcomes <i>(Note 1)</i>	Upon completion of the subject, students will be able to: - identify various cultural phenomena that can be observed in modern society and analyze their close relation to fashion in terms of the socio-cultural contexts; - build their own intellectual resources for developing critical and creative roles in the society based upon their understanding of contemporary fashion and culture; - explain the background of the contemporary cultural situations in order to anticipate the cultural trends in the future; - apply their insight built upon the knowledge obtained from this subject (i.e. how to interpret the social changes or significant cultural phenomenon through the study of the fashion style of the specific time and place or how to optimize the collected data for anticipating the upcoming cultural trends and/or fashion style) in order to become leaders in various fields who are capable of influencing or creating cultural phenomena in the future; - fulfil English reading and writing requirements.

Subject Synopsis/ Indicative Syllabus <i>(Note 2)</i>	1. Basic Theory of Fashion and Culture -The basic study of fashion and culture -Relationship between fashion and culture 2. Pop culture and Fashion -Pop culture (music, film, and TV) and its influence on fashion 3. Art and Fashion -General theory and history of the close relationship between art and fashion -Art meets fashion 4. Subculture and Fashion -What is subculture? -Street fashion: visual communication of subculture 5. Ecology and Fashion - Basic concept of “Eco-Friendly” - Roles of fashion to create eco-friendly culture and environment 6. One more chapter will be added to deal with significant contemporary issues. These issues will change whenever the class is offered to reflect on up-to-the-moment changes in the current fashion.
Teaching/Learning Methodology <i>(Note 3)</i>	Lectures using visual and written references will be given to facilitate students’ understanding of the subject. A summary of each lecture’s content will be distributed to students weekly. Self-study video lectures and related articles will be provided to students for gaining fundamental knowledge of subject contents and accompanying concept-check exercise. For assessment, students are required to participate in in-class activity (including but not limited to student sharing, online engagement and group discussion during the lecture) and post-class assignment. In order to engage students’ participation, they are required to provide a presentation related to the topics covered during the lecture. One or two groups of students will present their study topic weekly. To enhance students’ literacy and critical thinking, reading assignments will be given. For the assessment, students are required to complete a group presentation containing a summary as well as topics for further discussion derived from the reading material. For the English Writing requirement, students are required to have two submissions to ELC staff, The first submission should be an essay plan supported by academic sources, and the second submission should be a draft of around 1,500 words. ELC staff will provide writing support and consultation. Students will propose their own topic developed from the preliminary research and the instructors will provide feedback. They will have the opportunity to discuss their research topics with the instructor during the course. The revised final draft will be collected at the end of the course.

Assessment Methods in Alignment with Intended Learning Outcomes

(Note 4)

Specific assessment methods/tasks	% weighting	Intended subject learning outcomes to be assessed (Please tick as appropriate)				
		a	b	c	d	e
1. Assignment	30	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
2. Term Paper (including 10% of EW assessed by ELC and 30% by subject teacher on content)	40	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
3. Group presentation	30	✓	✓	✓		✓
Total	100 %					

Explanation of the appropriateness of the assessment methods in assessing the intended learning outcomes:

1. Assignment will be given to assess each student's understanding of the subject content. Pre-class concept-check exercise, in-class interactive activities and post-class assignment based on topics will be given.
2. In order to develop and improve the students' level of literacy and higher-order thinking, a term paper (the number of words requirement of the paper is 1500 – 2500 words for English) will be assigned. Students must perform research activities to collect information they need regarding the given topic(s). Students are required to have two submissions. The first submission should be an essay plan supported by academic sources, and the second submission should be a draft of around 1,500 words. The grade assigned for these writing activities will account for 10% of the subject's final grade. Students must obtain a D or above on the Writing Requirement assignment to pass the subject.
3. Students will be organized into teams and each team will give a presentation weekly. This assignment is to assess each student's ability to work as a member of the team, develop presentation skills, and identify the interesting and significant topics related to contemporary fashion and culture.
4. Reading assignments will be assessed by the discussion topics/issues students draw out of the reading materials.
5. Class attendance and active participation during the presentation will be assessed.
6. Students are allowed to use Generative AI tools for the development of the assessment, including earlier stage research, visual study, inspiration seeking, creative thinking, concept development, etc., in which students are required to have proper declaration and clear elaboration on the level of GenAI in their work. Submitting GenAI-generated materials as students' own work or part of their work without declaration and elaboration is an

	act of academic dishonesty. Students who are found committing academic dishonesty will face disciplinary actions.	
Student Study Effort Expected	Class contact:	
	▪ Lectures	39 Hrs.
	Other student study effort:	
	▪ Project and assignments (presentation and term paper)	55 Hrs.
	▪ Self-study	25 Hrs.
	Total student study effort	119 Hrs.
Reading List and References	Required Reading (Total 296 pages) 1. Basic Theory of Fashion and Culture - <i>Communicating Fashion: Clothing, Culture, and Media</i> “Chapter 2: Clothing as Intra- and Interpersonal Communication”, P.25-46 (22 pages) - <i>Fashion and Cultural Studies</i> “Chapter 2: Intersectional, Transnational Fashion Subjects”, P.31-50 (20 pages) 2. Pop culture and Fashion - <i>Communicating Fashion: Clothing, Culture, and Media</i> “Chapter 6: Clothing on Film and Television”, P.119-146 (28 pages) - <i>A Cultural History of Western Fashion: From Haute Couture to Virtual Couture</i> “Chapter 5: The Popularization of Fashion”, P.95-118 (24 pages) 3. Art and Fashion - <i>Communicating Fashion: Clothing, Culture, and Media</i> “Chapter 9: Fashion, Clothing and/as Art”, P.195-216 (22 pages) - <i>A Cultural History of Western Fashion: From Haute Couture to Virtual Couture</i> “Chapter 2: The Artistry of Fashion”, P.25-48 (24 pages) 4. Subculture and Fashion - <i>Communicating Fashion: Clothing, Culture, and Media</i> “Chapter 3: Clothing Dynamics in Groups and Cultures”, P.47-72 (26 pages) - <i>Fashion and Cultural Studies</i> “Chapter 8: Sexual Subjectivities and Style-Fashion-Dress”, p.165-188 (24 pages) 5. Ecology and Fashion - <i>Sustainability and Social Change in Fashion</i> “Chapter 2: Diversity, Equity, Inclusion, and Social Justice”, P.27-52 (26 pages) “Chapter 4: Longevity of Use”, P.81-110 (30 pages) 6. Issues in the Contemporary Fashion - <i>A Cultural History of Western Fashion: From Haute Couture to Virtual Couture</i> “Chapter 11: The Digitization of Fashion”, P.229-254 (26 pages) - <i>Communicating Fashion</i> “Chapter 8: Digital Communication, Social Media and Mediatization”, P.171-194 (24 pages)	

	Reference Brownie, B., Graydon, D., & Eicher, J. B. (2015). <i>The Superhero Costume: Identity and Disguise in Fact and Fiction (Dress, Body, Culture)</i>. Bloomsbury Academic. Burns, D. L. (2019). <i>Sustainability and Social Change in Fashion</i>. Fairchild Books. English, B., & Munroe, N. H. (2022). <i>A Cultural History of Western Fashion: From Haute Couture to Virtual Couture</i> (3rd ed.). Bloomsbury Visual Arts. Entwistle, J. (2015). <i>The Fashioned Body: Fashion, Dress and Social Theory</i> (2nd ed.). Polity. Fink, E., Marino, S., & Matteucci, G. (Ed.). (2023). <i>Fashion: Seductive Play</i>. London: Bloomsbury Visual Arts. Geczy, A., & Karaminas, V. (2020). <i>Libertine Fashion: Sexual Freedom, Rebellion, and Style</i>. London: Bloomsbury Visual Arts. Geczy, A., & Karaminas, V. (2024). <i>Queer Style</i>. London: Bloomsbury Visual Arts. Gelder, K. (2007). <i>Subcultures: Cultural Histories and Social Practice</i>. Abingdon, Oxon; New York: Routledge. Hyland, V. (2022). <i>Dress Code: Unlocking Fashion from the New Look to Millennial Pink</i> (Bilingual ed.). Harper Perennial. Kaiser, S. B., & Green, D. N. (2022). <i>Fashion and Cultural Studies</i> (2nd ed.). Bloomsbury Visual Arts. Lascity, M. E. (2021). <i>Communicating Fashion: Clothing, Culture, and Media</i>. Bloomsbury Visual Arts. Lifter, R. (2020). <i>Fashioning Indie: Popular Fashion, Music and Gender</i>. London: Bloomsbury Visual Arts. Marra-Alvarez, M., & Way, E. (Ed.). (2022). <i>Food and Fashion</i>. London: Bloomsbury Visual Arts. Mida, I. E. (2020). <i>Reading Fashion in Art</i>. Bloomsbury Visual Arts. Sikarskie, A., Liu, P., & Lan, L. (2023). <i>Male Idols and Branding in Chinese Luxury: Fashion, Cosmetics, and Popular Culture</i>. London: Bloomsbury Visual Arts. Wachenfeldt, P.v., & McIntyre, M.P. (Ed.). (2023). <i>Luxury Fashion and Media Communication: Between the Material and Immaterial</i>. London: Bloomsbury Visual Arts.
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Note 1: Intended Learning Outcomes

Intended learning outcomes should state what students should be able to do or attain upon subject completion. Subject outcomes are expected to contribute to the attainment of the overall programme outcomes.

Note 2: Subject Synopsis/Indicative Syllabus

The syllabus should adequately address the intended learning outcomes. At the same time, overcrowding of the syllabus should be avoided.

Note 3: Teaching/Learning Methodology

This section should include a brief description of the teaching and learning methods to be employed to facilitate learning, and a justification of how the methods are aligned with the intended learning outcomes of the subject.

Note 4: Assessment Method

This section should include the assessment method(s) to be used and its relative weighting, and indicate which of the subject intended learning outcomes that each method is intended to assess. It should also provide a brief explanation of the appropriateness of the assessment methods in assessing the intended learning outcomes.